

## Power shifts to red state colleges

Trump’s attacks on the Ivy League may drive money and students to the South, Midwest

**By Hillary Burns, Diti Kohli, and Liz Kowalczyk**  
GLOBE STAFF

COLUMBIA, Mo. — Deep within a 1960s-era building, a short drive from the University of Missouri’s flagship campus, a light blue glow radiates from the core of the school’s nuclear research reactor. It is the pride of Miz-zou’s research apparatus — and an emblem of its ambition.

The reactor, not to be confused

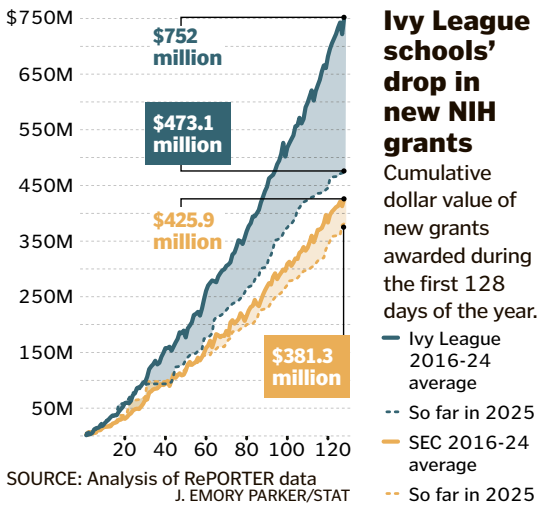
with a nuclear power plant, is used for cancer research. It produces the active ingredient for a promising new category of drugs. It’s aging, though, and the university needs hundreds of millions from the federal government to replace it.

The school’s leaders are bullish about their prospects of getting the money. The Trump administration’s assault on science at elite East Coast schools, which the president says must

be punished for indoctrinating students with leftist ideology and allowing antisemitism to flourish, barely registers here.

“A lot of higher education is in a political food fight because they don’t like the flavor of the current leadership,” said Todd Graves, chair of the University of Missouri board. “We keep our head down, we educate the students, we conduct the research,

**COLLEGES, Page A10**



## A FAMILY SEEKS ANSWERS ... AND CHANGES



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Esaie Joseph and Andrea Edmond, father and grandmother of 5-year-old Lens Arthur Joseph, wept at their Hyde Park home.

Lens Joseph, 5, was struck and killed in April by the BPS school bus that dropped him off. His family wants to know what went wrong.

**By John Hilliard**  
GLOBE STAFF

Lens Arthur Joseph woke up like he normally did that Monday morning in late April, the 5-year-old gently nudged awake by his grandmother.

Always fastidious in his appearance, he brushed his teeth and tongue, dressed, then tucked into his breakfast of bread, eggs, fruit, and milk. The family matriarch, Andrea Edmond, who cared for the boy as her own son, packed his school bag with homework and drawings of Spider-Man inside, then took her perch on the dark gray family couch to watch for the bus from the second-floor window.

It was a day like a hundred others — until it went terribly wrong.

That afternoon, Edmond was waiting for the bus when her adult daughter spotted police rushing around outside, but a neighbor’s home obstructed their view. The two women rushed out their door. In a moment, horror dawned on Edmond as she viewed the scene.

The school bus stopped a few doors down. Her granddaughter, on the sidewalk, screaming hysterically. The body, the size of a child, on the street. And no Lens.



Lens Arthur Joseph was fatally struck by a school bus in April.

Terror gripped Edmond like a vise, and she screamed at the police officer blocking her way.

*Let me see my grandson!*

There have been few answers in the nearly two months since Lens was struck and killed by his Boston Public Schools bus April 28, seconds after being dropped off at the wrong stop on the wrong side of the street with his 11-year-old cousin.

The driver has not been charged in connection with his death, while the Suffolk district attorney’s office and Boston police continue their investigation, and they have released no updates since the crash occurred.

Nearly a month following the crash, and after the Globe reported that the bus driver struck two other vehicles in Mattapan just minutes before the fatal crash, and tried to flee the Hyde Park scene, Mayor Michelle Wu and BPS Superintendent Mary Skipper announced an independent investigation

**LENS, Page A11**

## Plumber’s helper? Try plumbers’ hero.

At 80, F.W. Webb legend Jim Cain’s in no hurry to plunge into retirement

**By Beth Teitell**  
GLOBE STAFF

Jim Cain, a semireformed chain-smoking 80-year-old from Perry, Okla., with a wispy gray ponytail and a shy smile, didn’t set out to become a plumbing supply store legend. But then again, who even knew there *were* plumbing supply store legends?

But go to F.W. Webb in Watertown. Ask to see the man who knows every part ever manufactured — and, crucially, where, in the labyrinthine storeroom, or in the fraying pages of his enormous catalogs, it might be found. Say you’ve heard there’s a “hero” who can help a plumber or a homeowner eke another decade out of a faucet or toilet.

Mention you’ve been told that when he retires, God help us and our busted basket strainer locknuts.

And then? Well, prepare to feel like you’re in an infomercial for a man who is seeking no publicity (and who has picked up the detective-infused name of “Caino”).

“Caino?” said a plumber who, on a recent morning, was being helped by the man himself. “One of my instructors said, ‘If you ever have a question you can’t answer, there’s a guy in Watertown.’”

“Caino?” said that instructor, Nicholas Nocifora, of Wakefield’s PLUMR, when reached later by phone. “He’s a

**PLUMBING, Page A12**



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Jim Cain helped plumber David Waldron as he sought a shower diverter at the F.W. Webb store in Watertown.

## Teitelbaum worked to make MFA accessible

Director departing after 10 years of successes, setbacks

**By Malcolm Gay**  
GLOBE STAFF

On a recent afternoon, union members stood outside the Museum of Fine Arts calling on management to boost wages. Visitors wandered through the museum’s critically acclaimed van Gogh exhibition. The erstwhile Benin Kingdom Gallery, abruptly emptied after a donor retracted his gift, seemed forlorn, as workers prepared to renovate a separate suite of galleries for the museum’s modern collection.

Amid the bustle, Matthew Teitelbaum, the museum’s even-keeled director who will step down at the end of the month, nibbled at a corn muffin as he dissected the kaleidoscopic jumble of issues he’s had to navigate during the tumultuous decade he’s led New England’s premier art museum.

“I’ve said museums should be part of the street and part of everyday life,” Teitelbaum, 69, said while seated beneath a shade tree in the museum’s Calderwood Courtyard. “‘Well, Matthew: You better live with the consequences of that. We’re in it.’ ... We’re not exactly at a moment of calm in America.”

While previous generations of museum leaders were prized for their connoisseurship, sway with donors, and ability to build big, Teitelbaum has presided over the MFA as museums across the

**MFA, Page A12**

## Boxes of food for starving kids sit in R.I.

DOGE cuts made sending aid overseas more difficult

**By Tal Kopan**  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — More than three months after Elon Musk pledged to restart orders for a non-profit that makes food for starving children worldwide, nearly 200,000 boxes of life-saving, nutritional paste are still sitting in a Rhode Island warehouse.

The government has slowly undone some of the disruption since Musk dismantled the US Agency for International Development in January, which temporarily stopped all work for the non-profit Edesia of North Kingstown, R.I. It quickly restored contracts with the organization, and a few months later began paying for orders that Edesia had already filled. Last month, more than 120,000 boxes were finally sent to Sudan —the first outbound government shipment in roughly five months.

The Trump administration has said it supports buying the product, Ready-to-Use-Therapeutic, or

**FOOD, Page A9**

## Budget proposal passes key vote in Senate

Tense scenes played out as voting dragged on. Ultimately, two GOP lawmakers voted against. **A7.**

## Yard times

**Sunday:** Warmer, sun. High: 86-91. Low: 68-73. Complete report, **C22.** Obituaries, **C21.**

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